

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	30 September 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-1542
Project Name	AnswerBot – AI-powered FAQ and customer support automation
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template:

Brainstorming provides a free and open environment that encourages everyone within a team to participate in the creative thinking process that leads to problem solving. Prioritizing volume over value, out-of-the-box ideas are welcome and built upon, and all participants are encouraged to collaborate, helping each other develop a rich amount of creative solutions.

Use this template in your own brainstorming sessions so your team can unleash their imagination and start shaping concepts even if you're not sitting in the same room.

Reference: <https://www.mural.co/templates/brainstorm-and-idea-prioritization>

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

Team gathering. All four team members took part in the session. Time plan: 10 minutes to prepare, 1



Brainstorm & idea prioritization

Use this template in your own brainstorming sessions so your team can unleash their imagination and start shaping concepts even if you're not sitting in the same room.

🕒 10 minutes to prepare
🕒 1 hour to collaborate
👤 2-8 people recommended

➔

Before you collaborate

A little bit of preparation goes a long way with this session. Here's what you need to do to get going.

🕒 10 minutes

A Team gathering
Define who should participate in the session and send an invite. Share relevant information or pre-work ahead.

B Set the goal
Think about the problem you'll be focusing on solving in the brainstorming session.

C Learn how to use the facilitation tools
Use the Facilitation Superpowers to run a happy and productive session.

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1

Define your problem statement

What problem are you trying to solve? Frame your problem as a How Might We statement. This will be the focus of your brainstorm.

🕒 5 minutes

PROBLEM

How might we [your problem statement]?



Key rules of brainstorming

To run an smooth and productive session

➕ Stay in topic.

➕ Defer judgment.

🗣️ Go for volume.

💡 Encourage wild ideas.

👂 Listen to others.

👁️ If possible, be visual.

Set the goal. Priya, a customer support operations manager, spends hours answering the same questions again and again and cannot easily organise, classify or search them. Our goal is to design a secure backend that lets support teams create, manage and discover FAQs quickly with the help of AI.

Key rules of brainstorming: stay on topic · encourage wild ideas · defer judgment · listen to others · go for volume · if possible, be visual.

Define your problem statement.

PROBLEM – How might we...

How might we help support teams turn repetitive customer questions into an organised, searchable and secure FAQ knowledge base by using AI to draft answers and categories automatically?

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

Brainstorm. Each member wrote down ideas that address the problem statement (10 minutes).

2

Brainstorm
Write down any ideas that come to mind that address your problem statement.
🕒 10 minutes

TIP

You can select a sticky note and hit the pencil icon to start drawing!

Amar

Yuktresh

Person 3

Person 4

Person 5

Person 6

Person 7

Person 8

3

Group ideas
Take turns sharing your ideas while clustering similar or related notes as you go. In the last 10 minutes, give each cluster a sentence-like label. If a cluster is bigger than six sticky notes, try and see if you can break it up into smaller sub-groups.
🕒 20 minutes

Person 4

TIP

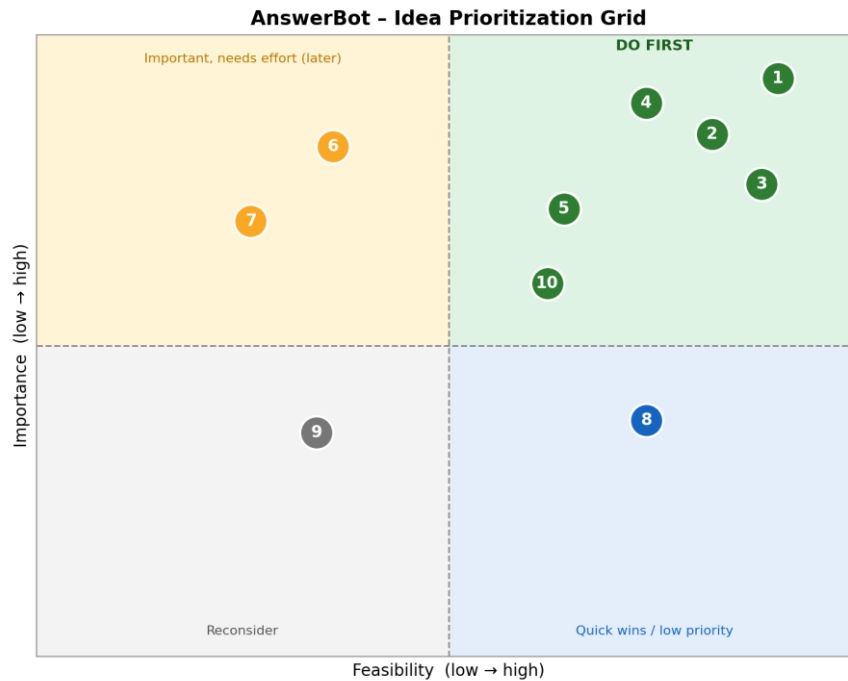
Add customisable tags to sticky notes to make it easier to find, browse, organise, and categorise important ideas as themes within your mural.

Group ideas. Similar ideas were clustered and each cluster was given a label (20 minutes).

A. Security & Access	B. AI Content Automation	C. Search & Discovery	D. Data & Architecture
• JWT login with role-based access • Author-only edit / delete • bcrypt password hashing • Centralised error handler	• Gemini FAQ generation from a topic • Auto-suggest category • AI-drafted support answers • Summarise long answers	• Keyword search • Category filter • Public read-only FAQ list • Trending questions	• Mongoose schema validation • Category management • MVC structure • API test collection

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

The team placed every idea on an importance vs. feasibility grid to decide what to build first. Importance asks: how much positive impact will this have on the user? Feasibility asks: how easily can we build it with our stack (Node.js, Express, MongoDB, Gemini) and time?



No.	Idea	Importance	Feasibility	Decision
1	JWT authentication & role-based access	High	High	Do first
2	FAQ CRUD with author-only edit/delete	High	High	Do first
3	Keyword search, category filter & public FAQ list	High	High	Do first
4	AI FAQ generation using Google Gemini	Very high	High	Do first
5	Category management	Medium-high	Medium-high	Do first
6	Semantic (meaning-based) search	High	Low-medium	Later
7	Analytics dashboard – trending questions	Medium-high	Low	Later
8	Postman / ThunderClient test collection	Low-medium	High	Quick win
9	Multi-language FAQ support	Low	Low	Reconsider
10	Centralised error handling & schema validation	Medium	Medium-high	Do first

Outcome: Ideas 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 and 10 (JWT security, FAQ CRUD, search and public list, Gemini FAQ generation, category management, error handling and validation) form the core of the first release. Semantic search and analytics are planned as later enhancements.

References

- Mural – Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization template: <https://www.mural.co/templates/brainstorm-and-idea-prioritization>
- Google Gemini API documentation: <https://ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs>